Authentication and Authorization using JWT Bearer Token

Overview



What is JWT Bearer Token?

Authentication Flow

Token Structure

Token Decoding

What is JWT Bearer Token?

- **A JWT (JSON Web Token)** Bearer Token is a type of access token that is commonly used in authentication and authorization mechanisms on the internet.
- Bearer tokens are a way for a client (such as a user's device or a software application) to prove its identity to a server when making requests to access protected resources.

- **Here's how a JWT Bearer Token typically works:**

Authentication: When a user logs in or an application requests access to a resource, an authentication server or identity provider validates the user's credentials.

Token Generation: Upon successful authentication, the authentication server generates a JWT Bearer Token. This token is a compact, URL-safe JSON-based data structure that contains claims about the user and some additional information.

Token Issuance: The JWT Bearer Token is issued to the client, which could be a web application, a mobile app, or any other service that needs access to protected resources.

Token Usage: The client includes the JWT Bearer Token in the "Authorization" header of HTTP requests when accessing protected resources from the server.

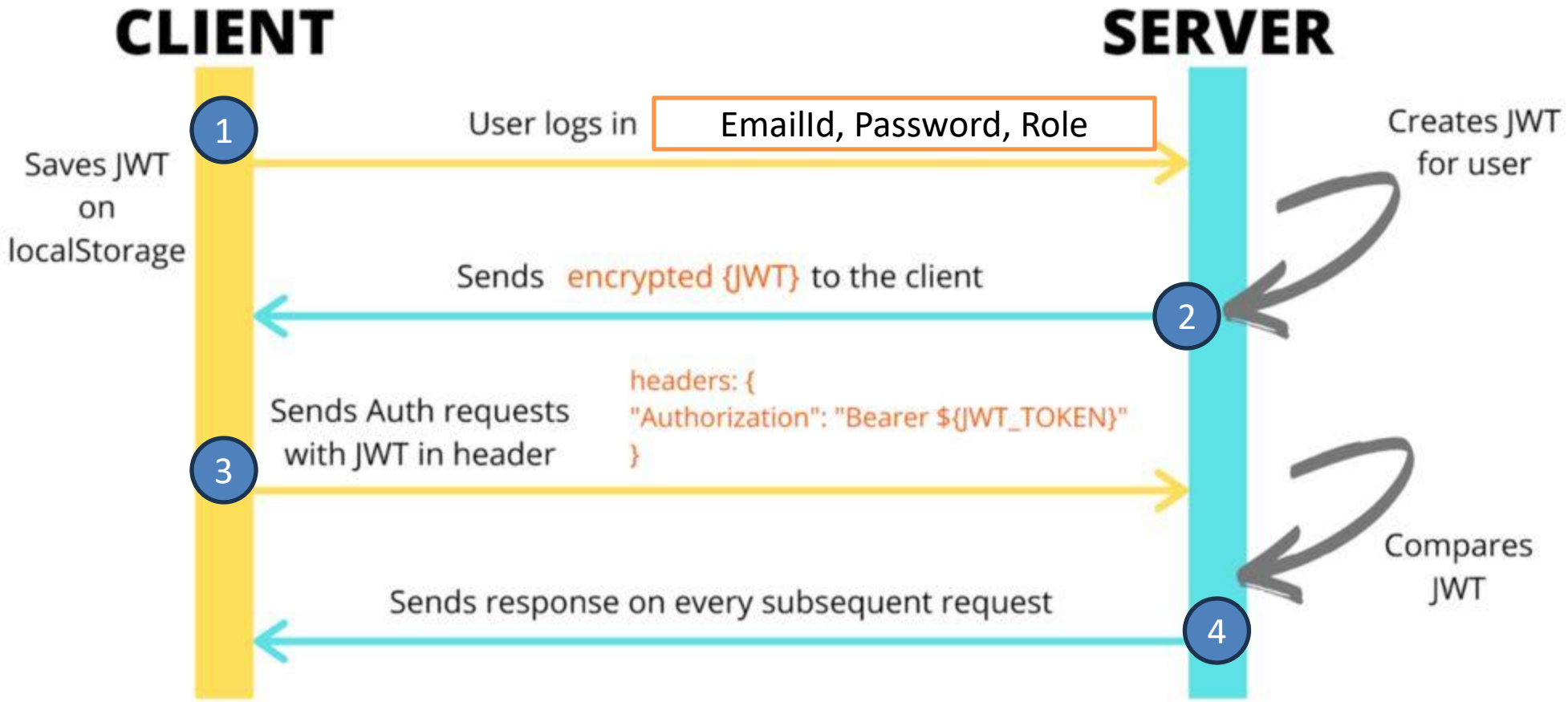
Server Verification: The server that hosts the protected resources receives the request and extracts the JWT Bearer Token from the "Authorization" header. It then validates the token's signature, expiration, and other claims to ensure its authenticity and integrity.

Authorization: If the token is valid, the server uses the information contained within it to determine if the client is allowed to access the requested resource. This authorization process may involve checking permissions, roles, or other access control rules associated with the user or client.

It's important to note that JWTs are typically used over **HTTPS** to ensure that the tokens are transmitted securely.

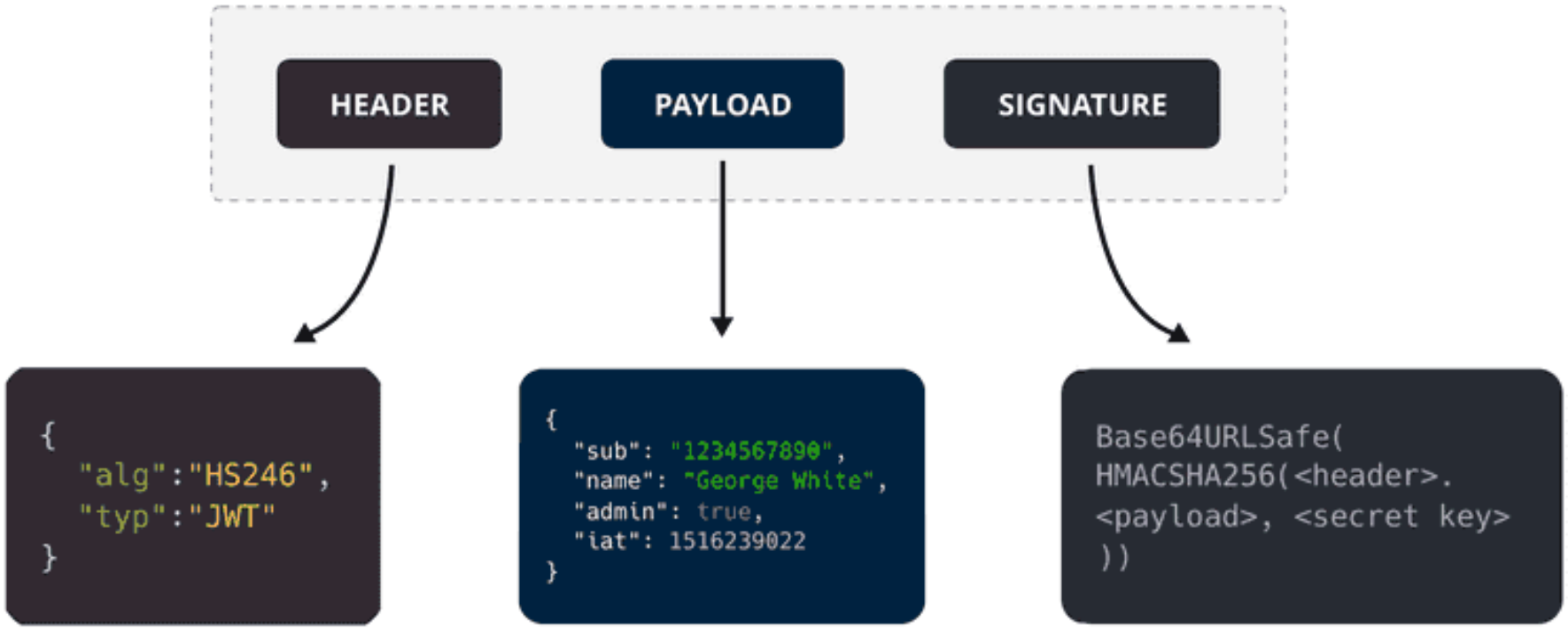
Authentication Flow

Token Based Authentication



Token Structure

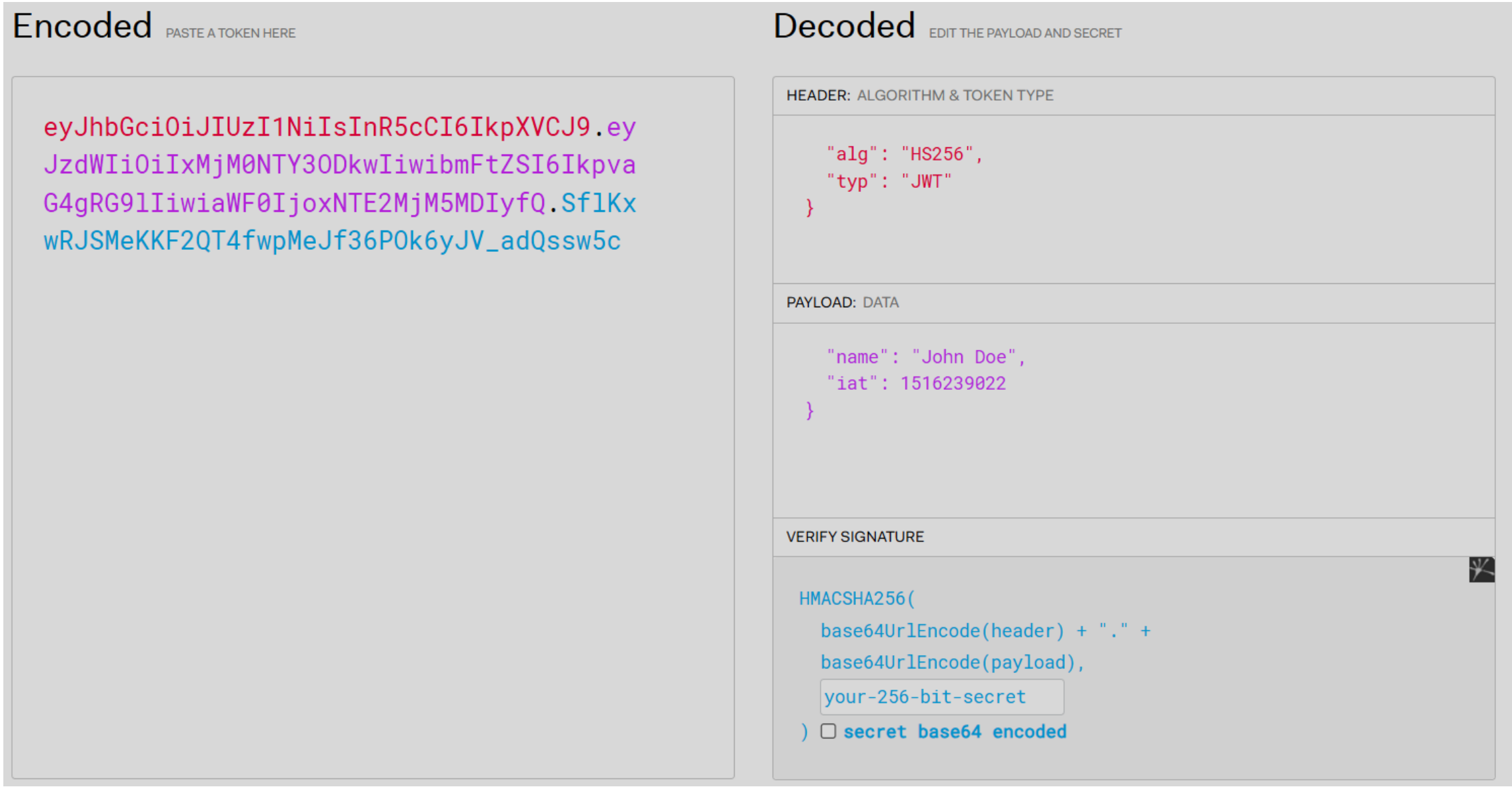
Structure of a JSON Web Token (JWT)



SuperTokens

Token Decoding

https://jwt.io/#debugger-io



References

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